

Jidi Cao

Business School, Sichuan University
610064 Chengdu, China
Research interests: Corporate finance, corporate governance, sustainability
Research tools: Text analysis, LLM, Agentic AI

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EDUCATION

Sept 2022 – Jun 2026	PhD in Corporate Finance Business School, Sichuan University (Sichuan, China) #11 in 2022 Best Chinese Universities Ranking by Shanghai Ranking ↔ Advisor: Prof. Haiyue Liu
Sept 2023 – Sept 2024	Visiting PhD Candidate in Finance TUM School of Management, Technical University of Munich (Heilbronn, Germany) #22 in QS World University Rankings 2026 ↔ Host: Prof. Sebastian Müller, CFA
Sept 2019 – May 2020	MSc in International Accounting and Finance EDHEC Business School (Nice, France) #7 in the European Business School Rankings 2022 by Financial Times
Sept 2015 – Jun 2019	Bachelor in Financial Accounting Sichuan Agricultural University (Sichuan, China)

WORKING PAPERS & PROJECTS

1. Cao, J. (2026). Silencing the green engine: How shareholder voice suppresses innovation. (*Job Market Paper*)

Using a large language model approach to classify environmental shareholder proposals, we find that proposals advancing to a public vote significantly suppress green innovation. Evidence from media coverage and executive compensation is consistent with a multitasking mechanism in which activism increases short-term reputational pressures while weakening incentives for long-horizon investment. However, environmental activism successfully promotes innovation for firms with ex ante environmental deficiencies and during periods of acute climate sentiment. Our findings highlight an unintended friction of public ESG engagement in the absence of informed target selection and timing.

2. Breitung C., Cao, J., & Müller S. (2026). Words of (No-) Action: Regulatory Discretion and Governance Frictions. (*Work in Progress*)

This project focuses on SEC's Rule 14a-8 no-action process, a critical regulatory gateway for shareholder activism. Employing optical character recognition (OCR) and large language model (LLM) based contextual reasoning, we construct a novel dataset encompassing over 5,300 SEC no-action letters to trace the full life cycle of shareholder proposals. By quantifying the rhetorical dynamics, legal justifications, and sentiment embedded in the tripartite correspondence among target management, proposing shareholders, and SEC staff, we uncover the benefits and costs in the regulatory review process.

CONFERENCES & PRESENTATIONS

- Workshop on corporate governance in the era of climate change (Guest speaker: Prof. Roni Michaely (University of Hong Kong)), Sichuan University, *Co-organizer* (Est. 2026, Chengdu, China)
- Swedish House of Finance and the European Corporate Governance Institute (ECGI) SHoF's Annual Conference on Corporate Governance, *Participant* (August 27–28, 2024, Stockholm, Sweden)
- The 2nd European Sustainable Finance PhD Workshop, *Participant* (June 18–29, 2024, Augsburg, Germany)
- ESG risk management framework for the financial sector by SUEF, *Participant* (May 29, 2024, Vienna, Austria)
- Workshop on current research trends in sustainable finance by TUM School of Management, *Poster presenter* (November 16–17, 2023, Heilbronn, Germany)

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

4. Liu, H., Wang, Y., & Cao, J. (2025). Green credit policy and investment-financing maturity mismatch: evidence from China's green companies. *Environment, Development and Sustainability*, 1–24. (SCIE Q2, IF 4.2)
5. Cao, J., Wang, Y., & Liu, H. (2024). Stock market reaction to new energy vehicle industry development plan: an event study in China. *Climate Policy*, 1–15. (SSCI Q1, IF 6.5)
6. Yang, X., Zou, A., Cao, J., Lai, Y., & Zhang, J. (2023). Systemic risk prediction based on Savitzky-Golay smoothing and temporal convolutional networks. *Electronic Research Archive*, 31(5), 2667–2688. (SCIE Q1)

7. Yang, X., **Cao, J.**, Liu, Z., & Lai, Y. (2022). Environmental policy uncertainty and green innovation: A TVP-VAR-SV model approach. *Quantitative Finance and Economics*, 6(4), 604–621. (ESCI-indexed)

8. **Cao, J.**, Chen, X., Qiu, R., & Hou, S. (2021). Electric vehicle industry sustainable development with a stakeholder engagement system. *Technology in Society*, 67, 101771. (ABS2*, SSCI Q1, IF 10.1)

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

- **Languages:** English (Proficient), French (Basic), Mandarin Chinese (Native)
- **Technical Skills:** LLM (training & fine-tuning), NLP, text analysis, web scraping
- **Databases:** SEC EDGAR, SEC Form 13F, ISS Shareholder Proposals, ISS ECA, Refinitiv, Compustat, CRSP, FactSet
- **Certificates:** Bloomberg Market Concepts, Certificate of Junior Accountant (Chinese)
- **Programming:** Stata, Python, L^AT_EX

TEACHING

Sept 2024 – Jan 2025	Teaching Assistant Class: <i>Software Design Basic and Python Programming</i> Bachelor program of Business Administration at the Business School of Sichuan University
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OTHER EXPERIENCE

Aug 2020 – Feb 2021	Financial Analyst Finance and Payment Department, PingPong Europe S.A., Luxembourg • Initiated wire transfer, managed virtual accounts, and facilitated automation payment projects • Prepared PI/EMI legal reporting to Commission de Surveillance du Secteur Financier • Collaborated with compliance team in KYC and AML using Moody’s RDC screening
Aug–Oct 2017	Field Researcher Governmental Field Survey, Aba Prefecture of China • On-site field surveys and independent evaluation of China’s Targeted Poverty Alleviation Policy in underdeveloped areas

GRANTS & AWARDS

- State Scholarship Fund by China Scholarship Council (CSC) of Ministry of Education of the P.R. China (2023–2024)
- Doctoral student scholarship (2022–2026)

REFERENCES

Vinod Singhal Charles W. Brady Chair Professor Scheller College of Business, Georgia Institute of Technology vinod.singhal@scheller.gatech.edu	Haiyue Liu Professor of Accounting and Finance Business School, Sichuan University seamoon@scu.edu.cn
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